



YOU ARE **22 WEEKS AND 5 DAYS**

121 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Extremely fine hairs called lanugo hairs cover your baby's entire skin surface. These are constantly shed and replaced but, during the final few weeks of pregnancy, will be replaced by thicker, permanent hairs. Lanugo cells help insulate the skin.

“The occasional dizzy spell is common in pregnancy and not a sign that anything is wrong.”

As your body works hard to nourish your developing baby, you may find that you have dizzy spells from time to time. It's common to feel dizzy when you stand up suddenly; although your blood supply has increased, getting up quickly causes the blood to rush into your legs. This reduces the supply of blood to your brain, making you feel lightheaded.

Dizziness can also be a symptom of [anemia](#). Although your body produces more red blood cells in pregnancy, your blood volume also increases. This means that proportionally there are fewer red blood cells and your blood count will drop. You may also become low in iron and may need iron supplements.

In addition to dizziness, symptoms of anemia include fatigue and shortness of breath. Low blood-sugar levels (see [Know your carbs](#)) can also cause dizziness and can be prevented by making sure you eat regularly.

Although dizziness is likely to be due to the physiological changes in pregnancy, inform your doctor so that you can be examined and have any relevant blood tests done.

If you feel dizzy when you're out of the house, or if you need a seat on a bus, train, or subway because you feel that you might faint, always tell someone—the majority of people will be kind and understanding, and will let you sit down. Wearing “a baby on board” button can help with this.

ASK A MOM

I'm only just over halfway through my pregnancy, but I don't feel up to socializing anymore. Should I force myself to go out? I remember that feeling well! It's normal to feel like battenning down the hatches sometimes because you're too tired to socialize.

It's worthwhile, however, to try to make the most of your leisure time before your baby arrives. You may not feel like getting out, but once you do, you'll probably be glad you made the effort and it will help you maintain friendships. When I was pregnant, I chose my activities carefully,